

Impact Medium · Difficulty Medium · Misuse risk It fails when the pause turns theatrical — too long, filled with staring, or used

## THE MOVE

Notice the key point or pressure, breathe, say or receive the line, pause one beat, then continue only with the next necessary move. -> Before answering: "Let me take a second with that." [pause] "The cleanest answer is..." -> After a point: "Th...

## START HERE

After an important sentence, close your mouth and count one slow beat before adding anything else.

## SAY THIS

|                            |                                                             |
|----------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|
| Before responding u...     | <i>"Let me take a second with that."</i>                    |
| After a key point          | <i>"The main issue is trust, not speed."</i>                |
| After a question           | <i>"What would make this feel workable from your side?"</i> |
| Conflict / apology         | <i>"You are right. I interrupted you."</i>                  |
| Professional / leader...   | <i>"The trade-off is speed versus reliability."</i>         |
| Clinical-style / helpin... | <i>"Take your time."</i>                                    |

## AVOID

- There is an urgent safety or operational need to speak or act immediately
- You cannot keep your face neutral or warm — a cold pause reads as judgement
- The content is weak or evasive; a pause will only highlight it, not rescue it

## REMEMBER

**Pause after the sentence you most want to explain.**